KCE PATHWAYS · GRADES 4–5 · UNIT 5: CHARTING THE COURSE · WEEK 23 · SCIENCE

Decomposers and the Cycle of Matter

Name: _____ **Date:** _____

PRE-LESSON WARM-UP · DO THIS BEFORE YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

Pre-Lesson Warm-Up: What Do I Already Know?

Answer with what you know right now. It is OK to guess!

1. **Review (Week 22):** A frog sees a fly and flicks out its tongue. Write the steps from stimulus to response, using the words receptors, neurons, brain and muscles.

2. What happens to a pumpkin left outside for a few months? Describe what you think you would see.

3. Is a mushroom a plant? Explain why or why not.

4. Draw a fallen leaf on the forest floor. Draw and label two living things you think might help break it down.

5. Predict: Where do you think the matter in a rotting log goes? List as many places as you can.

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POST-LESSON CHALLENGE · DO THIS AFTER YOUR COMPUTER LESSON

Post-Lesson Activity: Follow the Matter

Use evidence from today's lesson. Write in complete sentences.

1. **Trace the matter.** A squirrel eats an acorn and later leaves droppings on the ground. Trace the matter from the air to the oak, the squirrel, the decomposers and back.

2. **Fix the compost problem.** Calixto's pile is dry and stays cool. What two things should he add, and how does each help the decomposers?

3. **Two-step problem (EPA, 2018).** Paper was 23.1 percent of U.S. waste and yard trimmings 12.1 percent. What percent were they together? How much more paper was there?

4. **Find the mistake.** "A fungus is a plant, so it makes food from sunlight." Explain what is wrong and how a fungus gets food.

★ **Challenge:** Draw the cycle of matter with four labeled stops: plants, animals, decomposers, air and soil. Add an arrow for energy from the Sun and explain why energy does not cycle.

Looking Ahead: Next week: Earth's Moving Plates: Earthquakes, Volcanoes and Mountains. Question to bring: why do earthquakes happen in some places more than others?